

CSS 143B: Computer Programming II

Winter 2025 | M/W 11:00AM - 1:00PM (UW2 141)

Instructor Information

Yusuf Pisan

- **Email:** pisan@uw.edu
- [Homepage](#) || [Research Group](#) || [All Course Evaluations](#) || [RateMyProfessors](#)
- **Office hours:** Wednesday 3:30-4:30pm, Thursday 1:15-2:15pm at UW1-260Q. Signup via [Canvas Calendar](#)
- If you cannot make any of the office hours, email me 3 dates/times that you are available and we'll arrange a time to meet.
- **Class Discord:** <https://discord.gg/5mEm92e>
- You can submit [anonymous feedback](#) for this class anytime during the quarter



COURSE DESCRIPTION

Transition from basic programming skills to a rigorous process of software development. Familiarization with higher level programming techniques (recursion, generic programming, stacks, queues, trees, searching, and sorting). Emphasizes connection between algorithmic thought and implementation. Prerequisite: minimum grade of 2.7 in CSS 161, CSS 142, or CSE 142. Co-requisite: CSSSKL 143.

REQUIRED COURSE MATERIALS AND COMPUTER REQUIREMENTS

- Zybooks will be the main textbook for this course. To get started, see <https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1795621/pages/textbooks> and complete the first assignment.
- **Computer Requirements:** All students are expected to have unfettered access to a personal computer (Windows, Mac, Linux, etc.) or netbook with broadband-speed Internet access. Student access to University computing resources fulfills this requirement. All students are assumed to be proficient with an office productivity suite and email. All students must enable their Canvas Notifications for this course to be at least as frequent as the defaults; if I post announcements, etc. via Canvas, you need to be able to receive them. All students must have a valid email account that they check on a daily basis.
- Bring your computer to each lecture. We will usually have in-class programming exercises.

COURSE SCHEDULE

See [Schedule](#) on Canvas

GRADING

Your course grade will be computed as in the following:

- In-Class Activities: 10%
- Homework: 25%
- Exams (15%, 25%, 25% each respectively): 65%

Your lowest 2 in-class activities grades will automatically be dropped. You can miss 2 classes without penalty, but I strongly recommend attending all classes as there is a high correlation between not attending class and failing the course.

Your lowest 2 homework grades will automatically be dropped. You can miss 2 homeworks without penalty, but I strongly recommend completing all homeworks as they will prepare you for the exams.

In general students who engage with the course get 90-100% in activities and in homeworks. The exam grades tend to be much lower, usually around 70-80%.

A scale of 90s (3.5â€4.0), 80s (2.5â€3.4), 70s (1.5â€2.4), 60s (0.5â€1.4) is a rough guide. A student who achieves 75% will receive a minimum of 2.0, 85% will receive a minimum of 3.0 and 95% and above will receive a 4.0 grade. Scores in between will be interpolated.

If you disagree with your grade for each assignment, please bring the issue to my attention within a week after I returned the graded work to you.

Late assignments will not be accepted. Zybooks assignments often have multiple sections. Make sure you complete all the assignment parts. I will make allowances for exceptional circumstances such as sickness, bereavement and official university business. I will not make exceptions for work, other classes, travel, personal obligations, etc.

Other than when working in pairs, talking about code is OK, looking at each others code is not OK. Looking at references to understand how a functions gets used is OK; looking up assignment solutions is not OK. Asking ChatGPT or other AI systems to solve your assignment is not OK. It is also not acceptable for your code or solutions to be publicly accessible on the web (for example, a public GitHub repository). Plagiarism will result in an assignment score of zero and a misconduct letter in your student record. Please be very careful to adhere to the student code of conduct: <http://www.washington.edu/cssc/for-students/student-code-of-conduct/>

GENERAL POLICIES AND EXPECTATIONS

Concurrent enrollment in CSSSKL 143 (A or B) required. Students will be dropped from CSS 143 if they are not enrolled in both CSS 143 and CSSSKL 143.

Attendance: Attend all classes. You are responsible for all the material covered in class, as well as any announcements including change of due dates or assignment specifications. There will also be graded in-class group exercises to practice problem solving. If you miss a class, I expect you to make-up for it on your own by asking your friends, reviewing the textbook, lecture materials, etc. Do not email me to ask "if there was anything important covered during class". I record all the lectures, but you should treat the recording as review material not as replacement to attending class. If you are not physically present in class, you do not get credit for the in-class exercise. This applies even if you had completed the exercise earlier or submit it remotely during the class time. Participating in the class discussion and helping others is part of the in-class activity not just uploading a solution to Canvas.

Communication: We will use discord as an extension of the classroom. Use a meaningful nickname and act professionally. If your question can be answered publicly by me or by a classmate, post it to discord. Use the office hours for complex issues or topics you are struggling with.

Use your [UW email](#) rather than "Canvas Messaging" to communicate directly with me. "Canvas Submission Comments" should only be used to draw the grader's attention to a specific part of your submission.

Access and Accommodations: Your experience in this class is important to me. If you have already established accommodations with Disability Resources for Students (DRS), please communicate your approved accommodations to me at your earliest convenience so we can discuss your needs in this course.

If you have not yet established services through DRS, but have a temporary health condition or permanent disability that requires accommodations (conditions include but not limited to; mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical or health impacts), you are welcome to contact DRS at 425-352-5307 or uwbdrs@uw.edu. DRS offers resources and coordinates reasonable accommodations for students with disabilities and/or temporary health conditions. Reasonable accommodations are established through an interactive process between you, your instructor(s), and DRS. It is the policy and practice of the University of Washington to create inclusive and accessible learning environments consistent with federal and state law.

Religious Accommodation Policy:

See <https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy/>

Problems: If you are having difficulties, come and talk to me. If I don't know about it, I cannot help you. Small problems can be fixed easily early in the quarter, but might become impossible to fix later on.

See the [School of STEM Course Policies](#), which covers:

- Academic Integrity
- Access and Accommodations
- Classroom Emergency Preparedness
- For Our Veterans
- Grade of Incomplete
- Inclement Weather
- Parenting Resources
- Religious Accommodations
- Respect for Diversity
- Student Support Services
- Surviving Sexual and Relationship Violence
- Wonder How to Address Faculty?

RESOURCES

Student Resources: A number of challenges from a variety of directions can affect your ability to bring your optimal attention and energy to a course. [Student Resources](#) is a set of links to campus resources that UW makes available to students in trying to mitigate and cope with some of these challenges.

UW Libraries: In this course you may be required to access a large number of databases through the Internet. Several of these databases are publicly available, but some are proprietary and access requires authentication through the [UW](#)

[Libraries](#). Information about logging in to use these databases is available on the [Connecting to the Libraries](#) page.

UWB CARE Team

UWB CARE Team is the contact point for providing support for students. <https://www.uwb.edu/student-affairs/care-team> CARE Team is also able to provide "Emergency Funding" up to \$1000 to students that can be used to help pay for textbooks, utility bills, medical bills, etc. To access the emergency funds, students need to go to <https://www.uwb.edu/student-affairs/care-team> and click on "online report" and enter their details. The same form can also be used by faculty and staff to report any concerns.